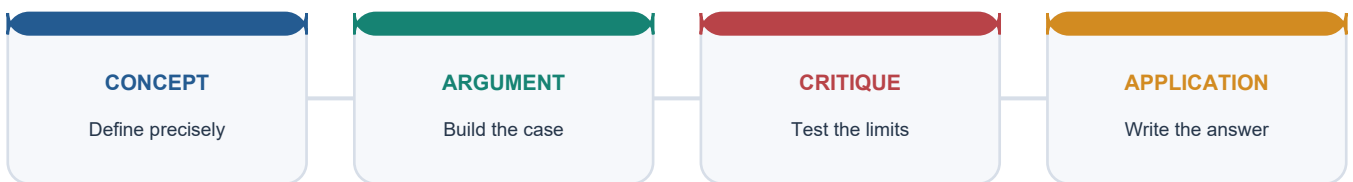


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Contemporary Democracy, Social Change and Development - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Contemporary Democracy, Social Change and Development - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 23 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Answer:?**

- A. democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- B. criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF pp.535-537).
- C. democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF pp.516-518).
- D. democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: the source records this exact proposition - democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).

- **C:** C Source disagrees: democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).
- **D:** D Misplaced: democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).

Examiner trap: Do not identify democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration made complete by the first election.
- B. policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority or a single elite (PDF pp.516-517).
- C. evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and dignity of labour, and resists consumerist civilization (PDF pp.566-568).
- D. is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within an order that may continue to hold elections.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B This is the recorded association: the source records this exact proposition - policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority or a single elite (PDF pp.516-517).
- **C:** C Misplaced: evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and dignity of labour, and resists consumerist is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify policy emerges from bargaining among relatively by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is policy emerges from bargaining among relatively.

MCQ 3

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF pp.516-518).
- B. rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF pp.551-554).
- C. democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- D. democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).

- **B:** B Misplaced: rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).
- **C:** C Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).

Examiner trap: Do not identify democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy.

MCQ 4

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority or a single elite (PDF pp.516-517).
- B. is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within an order that may continue to hold elections.
- C. is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration made complete by the first election.
- D. liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving toward substantive equality (PDF pp.523-535).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving toward substantive equality (PDF pp.523-535).

Examiner trap: Do not identify liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois.

MCQ 5

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. democratic legitimacy grows when citizens and representatives justify public decisions through reasoned discussion while respecting personal freedom (PDF).
- B. liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving toward substantive equality (PDF pp.523-535).
- C. is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within an order that may continue to hold elections.
- D. later theory commonly connects deliberative democracy to Habermasian public reasoning; use this as a comparative bridge, not as Gauba's own named attribution in this chapter window.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - democratic legitimacy grows when citizens and representatives justify public decisions through reasoned discussion while respecting personal freedom (PDF p.540).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Not this pair: later theory commonly connects deliberative democracy to Habermasian public reasoning; use this as a is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify democratic legitimacy grows when citizens and by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is democratic legitimacy grows when citizens and.

MCQ 6

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Meet present needs without destroying future capacity (PDF pp.568-572).
- B. rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).
- C. Social ownership, worker welfare and planned development (PDF pp.565-566).
- D. Modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF pp.562-563).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: meet present needs without destroying future capacity (PDF pp.568-572) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).
- **C:** C Not this pair: social ownership, worker welfare and planned development (PDF pp.565-566) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF pp.562-563) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540) by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).

MCQ 7

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF pp.562-563).
- B. change judged morally superior, not merely empirically different (PDF p.541).
- C. cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).
- D. Social security and redistribution within a market society (PDF pp.563-565).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF pp.562-563) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Not this pair: change judged morally superior, not merely empirically different (PDF p.541) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **C:** C Source-exact: the source records this exact proposition - cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: social security and redistribution within a market society (PDF pp.563-565) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more.

MCQ 8

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515).
- B. democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- C. rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF pp.551-554).
- D. movement toward stronger, more organized, more efficient and more satisfying institutions (PDF p.541).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515) is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).
- **C:** C Source disagrees: rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about).
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: the source records this exact proposition - movement toward stronger, more organized, more efficient and more satisfying institutions (PDF p.541).

Examiner trap: Do not identify movement toward stronger by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is movement toward stronger.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Answer: - change judged morally superior, not merely empirically different (PDF p.541).
- B. Answer: - Meet present needs without destroying future capacity (PDF pp.568-572).
- C. Answer: - cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).
- D. Answer: - rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - change judged morally superior, not merely empirically different (PDF - change judged morally superior, not merely empirically different (PDF; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Answer: - democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- B. Answer: - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515).
- C. Answer: - democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF pp.516-518).
- D. Answer: - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF pp.535-537).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 11

Which pair keeps the proposition with the name or concept the source attaches it to?

- A. Answer: - movement toward stronger, more organized, more efficient and more satisfying institutions (PDF p.541).
- B. Answer: - rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF pp.551-554).
- C. Answer: - democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism rather than undivided popular rule (PDF pp.516-518).
- D. Answer: - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism - democracy in practice resembles polyarchy or group-based pluralism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 12

Which pairing is exact, rather than borrowed from an adjacent part of the same topic?

- A. Answer: - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515).
- B. Answer: - rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF pp.551-554).
- C. Answer: - evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and dignity of labour, and resists consumerist civilization (PDF pp.566-568).
- D. Answer: - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF pp.535-537).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 13

One pairing below is faithful to the source. Which one?

- A. Answer: - rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over revolutionary total redesign (PDF pp.551-554).
- B. Answer: - democracy is a method by which leaders competitively acquire decision-making power through votes (PDF p.515).
- C. Answer: - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF pp.535-537).
- D. Answer: - movement toward stronger, more organized, more efficient and more satisfying institutions (PDF p.541).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

- **D: D** Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over - rejects historicist determinism and supports incremental reform over; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 14

Which label-proposition pair would not be corrected by the source text?

- **A. Answer:** - liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving toward substantive equality (PDF...
- **B. Answer:** - evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and dignity of labour, and resists consumerist civilization (PDF pp.566-568).
- **C. Answer:** - democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- **D. Answer:** - criticizes low-participation, market-style democracy and seeks a broader, human-developmental democracy (PDF pp.535-537).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A** Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B: B** Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C: C** Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D: D** Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and - evaluates development morally, prefers restrained consumption and; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 15

Which of the following associations is reproduced exactly as recorded?

- **A. Answer:** - cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).
- **B. Answer:** - Meet present needs without destroying future capacity (PDF pp.568-572).
- **C. Answer:** - Modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF pp.562-563).
- **D. Answer:** - rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A** Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B: B** Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C: C** Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D: D** Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - Modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF - Modernization through growth, competition and open economy (PDF; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 16

Which pair matches its proposition without drifting to a related concept?

- A. Answer: - rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).
- B. Answer: - Meet present needs without destroying future capacity (PDF pp.568-572).
- C. Answer: - cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).
- D. Answer: - Social security and redistribution within a market society (PDF pp.563-565).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Answer: - Social security and redistribution within a market society (PDF - Social security and redistribution within a market society (PDF; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Social ownership, worker welfare and planned development (PDF pp.565-566).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: later theory commonly connects deliberative democracy to Habermasian public reasoning; use this as a comparative bridge, not as Gauba's own named attribution in this chapter window.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration made complete by the first election.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration made complete by the first election.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 2 only.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Populism is a thin-centred ideology that divides society into a morally pure people and a corrupt elite, claims exclusive representation of the authentic popular will and treats pluralist mediation as suspect.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: is the incremental weakening of competition, accountability, civil liberties or institutional checks within an order that may continue to hold elections.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: are sustained collective efforts that organise claims outside or across routine electoral and party channels; they can widen participation, set agendas and create counter-publics for excluded groups.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: is the transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; it is a process, not a declaration made complete by the first election.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: liberal democracy is criticized as bourgeois; true democracy requires overcoming class domination and moving toward substantive equality (PDF pp.523-535).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 1 only.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: 2 only.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: are sustained collective efforts that organise claims outside or across routine electoral and party channels; they can widen participation, set agendas and create counter-publics for excluded groups.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority or a single elite (PDF pp.516-517).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.**"?

- A. Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF pp.518-522, 537-539).
- B. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- C. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).
- D. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF pp.518-522, 537-539).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Development is just GDP or growth.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Development is just GDP or growth."**?

- A. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).
- B. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- C. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- D. Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF pp.518-522, 537-539).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "'Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- **C:** C Mismatched: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "'Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Development is just GDP or growth.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Progress is a neutral empirical term."**?

- A. They are book-period/historical frames from a 2009 text and must be dated accordingly (PDF pp.555-561).
- B. Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF p.541).
- C. Progress involves a moral judgment that a new condition is better (PDF p.541).
- D. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "'Third world" or Soviet-bloc references in the chapter are timeless present facts.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "'Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Progress involves a moral judgment that a new condition is better (PDF p.541).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "'Development is just GDP or growth.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Progress is a neutral empirical term.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship."**?

- A. Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF pp.518-522, 537-539).
- B. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- C. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- D. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Development is just GDP or growth.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Third world" or Soviet-bloc references in the chapter are timeless present facts.**?

- A. They are book-period/historical frames from a 2009 text and must be dated accordingly (PDF pp.555-561).
- B. Participation is involvement; deliberation adds reasoned justification and mutual persuasion (PDF pp.518-522, 537-539).
- C. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- D. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: They are book-period/historical frames from a 2009 text and must be dated accordingly (PDF pp.555-561).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Participation and deliberation mean the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Development is just GDP or growth.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Third world" or Soviet-bloc references in the, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Answer: means rapid and abrupt transformation of the social system (PDF p.540).**?

- A. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- B. Answer: means democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- C. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).
- D. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Development is just GDP or growth.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Answer, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Answer: means cumulative and gradual transformation from simple to more complex forms (PDF p.540).**?

- A. Answer: means democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- B. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).
- C. Answer: means policy emerges from bargaining among relatively autonomous groups rather than from a single coherent majority or a single elite (PDF pp.516-517).
- D. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528); this option applies the proposition as a complete explanation.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Answer, not a different error from the same topic; here the tested item is Answer.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Answer: means movement toward stronger, more organized, more efficient and more satisfying institutions (PDF p.541).**?

- A. Gauba's development chapter includes social structure, welfare, rights, environment and political capability (PDF pp.555-576).
- B. Gauba presents it as a theory of class rule and socialist transition, not as a synonym for personal autocracy (PDF pp.525-528).
- C. Answer: means democracy means competitive selection of rulers by the people, not direct rule by the people themselves (PDF pp.514-516).
- D. Answer: means democracy requires active citizen involvement in policy and public life, not merely periodic voting (PDF pp.518-522).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Development is just GDP or growth.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Marxist democracy simply means one ruler's dictatorship.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Misplaced: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Answer, more, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish participatory democracy from deliberative democracy. Why is participation alone insufficient for democratic legitimacy? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of participatory democracy from deliberative democracy. Why is participation alone insufficient for democratic legitimacy in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Participatory, Core and Rousseau, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Participation widens democratic presence, but deliberation adds the reason-giving, revisability and accountability without which mobilisation alone cannot secure legitimacy.

Model answer (148 words):

Introduction: Participatory and deliberative democracy both criticise thin electoralism, but they are not identical because one widens political action while the other adds a test of public justification. Core analysis: Participatory democracy, drawing on Rousseau and later Macpherson-style arguments in the owner, insists that citizens must act beyond periodic voting through local bodies, petitions, monitoring, protest and other public interventions. Deliberative democracy accepts participation but asks an extra question: are claims justified through reasons that others can answer and revise? Participation expands sites of agency; deliberation disciplines those sites through reciprocity,

revisability and public reasoning. Critical evaluation: Deliberation cannot be idealised as frictionless. The strongest answer therefore treats participation as necessary democratic energy and deliberation as the legitimacy test that prevents activism from becoming mere aggregation or assertion. Conclusion: Participation widens democratic presence, but deliberation adds the reason-giving, revisability and accountability without which mobilisation alone cannot secure legitimacy.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Participatory, Core and Rousseau), converts that evidence into analysis of participatory democracy from deliberative democracy. Why is participation alone insufficient for democratic legitimacy, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Participation widens democratic presence, but deliberation adds the reason-giving, revisability and accountability without which mobilisation alone cannot secure legitimacy. At 148 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why must development be distinguished from both GDP growth and moral progress? Explain with reference to rights, welfare, ecology and political capability. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of must development be distinguished from both GDP growth and moral progress? Explain with reference to rights, welfare, ecology and political capability in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, GDP and Development, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Development therefore exceeds output and differs from moral progress: it concerns stronger human and political capabilities, while judgment of progress still depends on justice, rights and ecological limits.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: The canonical owner separates growth, development and progress because they answer different questions: how much is produced, what capacities and institutions improve, and whether the change is morally better. Core analysis: GDP growth measures output. Development is wider: stronger institutions, welfare provision, rights, political capability and more effective social organisation. Progress adds a normative claim that the new condition is superior. That is why a society may grow without developing if exclusion, environmental damage or political incapacity deepen, and may develop without unqualified progress if improved administration coexists with injustice. Critical evaluation: No single indicator resolves the issue. A sound verdict therefore treats development as capability-and-institution enlargement and reserves progress for a further moral evaluation of freedom, justice and sustainability. Conclusion: Development therefore exceeds output and differs from moral progress: it concerns stronger human and political capabilities, while judgment of progress still depends on justice, rights and ecological limits.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, GDP and Development), converts that evidence into analysis of must development be distinguished from both GDP growth and moral progress? Explain with reference to rights, welfare, ecology and political capability, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Development therefore exceeds output and differs from moral progress: it concerns stronger human and political capabilities, while judgment of progress still depends on justice, rights and ecological limits. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Examine whether elitist and pluralist theories explain democracy in mass society more realistically than participatory and deliberative theories. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of whether elitist and pluralist theories explain democracy in mass society more realistically than participatory and deliberative theories in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Modern, Core and Elitist, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Elitist and pluralist theories explain durable features of mass democracy, but a defensible account is fuller only when participatory and deliberative correctives restore agency, justification and contestability.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Modern democracy in mass society is torn between realism about leadership and the normative demand that the people remain more than periodic selectors. Core analysis: Elitist theory explains the organisational fact that leadership concentrates in relatively few hands; Schumpeter's procedural definition and Michels's oligarchic tendency capture that realism. Pluralism improves the picture by replacing one ruling elite with bargaining among several organised groups, a move associated with Dahl's polyarchy. Yet both perspectives can thin democracy into competition among better-placed actors. Participatory democracy replies that citizens must act beyond voting, while deliberative democracy adds that decisions need reason-giving, revisability and accountability rather than mere pressure or aggregation. Participatory and deliberative theories therefore remain necessary correctives, even if neither abolishes leadership or conflict. Conclusion: Elitist and pluralist theories explain durable features of mass democracy, but a defensible account is fuller only when participatory and deliberative correctives restore agency, justification and contestability.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Modern, Core and Elitist), converts that evidence into analysis of whether elitist and pluralist theories explain democracy in mass society more realistically than participatory and deliberative theories, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Elitist and pluralist theories explain durable features of mass democracy, but a defensible account is fuller only when participatory and deliberative correctives restore agency, justification and contestability. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare political modernisation with dependency and world-systems critiques. Why must development in India not be equated with Westernisation? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of political modernisation with dependency and world-systems critiques. Why must development in India not be equated with Westernisation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Modernisation and Coleman, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Modernisation illuminates institutional differentiation, yet dependency and world-systems critiques are indispensable because development is historically unequal and cannot be treated as a linear imitation of the West.

Model answer (236 words):

Introduction: Political modernisation and dependency theory are rival explanations of how development occurs, what blocks it, and which path is being falsely universalised. Core analysis: Modernisation approaches linked with Coleman, Pye, Almond and Powell emphasise differentiation of institutions, wider participation, secularisation and increased political capacity. Their strength is institutional analysis. Their weakness, stated in the owner, is teleology: Western industrial liberal democracy can become the implicit endpoint of a single developmental path. Dependency and world-systems critiques reverse the frame by arguing that underdevelopment is historically produced through unequal core-periphery relations rather than being a mere early stage. Further development: The Indian bridge should remain cautious and source-safe. Early mixed-economy planning can illustrate welfare-socialist choice, while linguistic reorganisation is a conceptual example of negotiating identity and integration rather than suppressing them. Neither illustration proves a theory by itself; each only shows why political development must be read through diversity, accommodation and historical structure. Critical evaluation: India cannot be read as a simple lagging copy of the West. The canonical additions on Kothari, mixed-economy planning and linguistic accommodation show a more negotiated pattern of nation-building and state-building. Development in India must therefore be judged through historical structure, social diversity and institutional capacity rather than through imitation of one model society. Conclusion: Modernisation illuminates institutional differentiation, yet dependency and world-systems critiques are indispensable because development is historically unequal and cannot be treated as a linear imitation of the West.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Modernisation and Coleman), converts that evidence into analysis of political modernisation with dependency and world-systems critiques. Why must development in India not be equated with Westernisation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Modernisation illuminates institutional differentiation, yet dependency and world-systems critiques are indispensable because development is historically unequal and cannot be treated as a linear imitation of the West. At 236 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Democracy may survive elections yet lose substance when participation, rights, accountability and ecological limits are neglected. Critically discuss with reference to development models and India-specific change. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of may survive elections yet lose substance when participation, rights, accountability and ecological limits are neglected. Critically discuss with reference to development models and India-specific change in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Gandhian and Further, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: A democracy of elections without inclusion, accountability and ecological restraint becomes formally surviving but substantively thinned;.

Model answer (244 words):

Introduction: The canonical file repeatedly insists that elections are necessary but not sufficient for democratic legitimacy, and that development is legitimate only when judged beyond output alone. Core analysis: A democracy may continue to vote while losing substance if opposition weakens, rights narrow, accountability thins or participation becomes merely formal. The same file shows that development models embody rival moral logics: market growth privileges productivity and competition, welfare models soften exclusion, socialist paths prioritise social ownership, Gandhian development stresses restraint and labour dignity, and sustainable development imposes ecological limits on present gain. The integrated lesson is that growth without voice or ecological prudence can hollow both democracy and development. Further development: The climate-development conflict requires one further distinction from the owner: ecological political theory is not the same as a sustainable-development slogan. Productivism across market, welfare and socialist models is criticised because unlimited throughput cannot be the master political goal forever. A just-transition answer therefore joins ecological restraint to compensation, participation and legitimacy rather than opposing development and environment as absolute enemies. Critical evaluation: The strongest counterpoint is that too many veto points can immobilise urgent reform, and that democratic politics sometimes underweights long-horizon ecological costs. A graded answer must defend checks, participation and sustainability while conceding that institutions also need capacity, coordination and lawful decision. Conclusion: A democracy of elections without inclusion, accountability and ecological restraint becomes formally surviving but substantively thinned; legitimate development must therefore join growth to rights, participation and sustainability.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Gandhian and Further), converts that evidence into analysis of may survive elections yet lose substance when participation, rights, accountability and ecological limits are neglected. Critically discuss with reference to development models and India-specific change, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: A democracy of elections without inclusion, accountability and ecological restraint becomes formally surviving but substantively thinned;. At 244 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Distinguish democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements, and evaluate how populism and digital mediation can either widen or corrode democratic life. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *distinguish* requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements, and evaluate how populism and digital mediation can either widen or corrode democratic life in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Democratisation and Democratic, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Democratisation, backsliding and social movements mark different democratic processes, and populist or digital mediation should be judged not by noise or novelty but by whether they enlarge plural, accountable and informed public agency.

Model answer (250 words):

Introduction: The supplemental bridge in Section 24 distinguishes three different democratic processes: movement toward wider accountable rule, erosion within electoral survival, and collective claim-making outside routine party channels. Core analysis: Democratisation is a transition toward more competitive, inclusive and accountable rule; its test is not the first election alone but civil liberties, opposition access and institutionalised uncertainty. Democratic backsliding is the opposite process: gradual weakening of competition, liberties, information pluralism or checks while

elections continue. Social movements are sustained collective efforts that organise claims outside or across ordinary electoral channels and can widen participation, create counter-publics and set agendas. Populism intersects with this field when a movement claims exclusive representation of a morally pure people against a corrupt elite, while digital mediation reshapes consent, representation and the public sphere through targeting, disintermediation and fragmented visibility. Further development: The answer gains depth when it separates process from label. Democratisation names widening contestation and accountable succession; backsliding names incremental erosion; social movements name organised claim-making. Populism becomes dangerous when exclusive representation turns opposition and independent institutions into enemies, and digital mediation becomes dangerous when differential information or fragmented publicity weakens informed and revisable consent. Critical evaluation: The concepts must not be collapsed. The decisive question is whether plural contestation, informed consent and institutional checks are being enlarged or weakened. Conclusion: Democratisation, backsliding and social movements mark different democratic processes, and populist or digital mediation should be judged not by noise or novelty but by whether they enlarge plural, accountable and informed public agency.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Democratisation and Democratic), converts that evidence into analysis of democratisation, democratic backsliding and social movements, and evaluate how populism and digital mediation can either widen or corrode democratic life, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Democratisation, backsliding and social movements mark different democratic processes, and populist or digital mediation should be judged not by noise or novelty but by whether they enlarge plural, accountable and informed public agency. At 250 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
